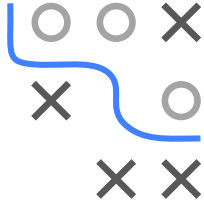
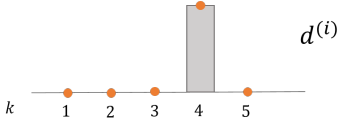
Supervised Learning



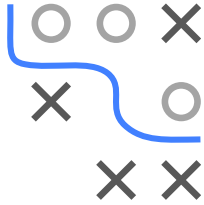
Information Theory
Information Theory for Machine Learning



Learning goals

- Minimizing KL =
  maximizing log-likelihood
- Minimizing KL =
  minimizing cross-entropy
- Minimizing CE between modeled and
  observed probabilities =
  log-loss minimization

KL VS MAXIMUM LIKELIHOOD I



Minimizing KL between the true distribution $p(x)$ and approximating model $q(x|\boldsymbol{\theta})$ is equivalent to maximizing the log-likelihood.

$$\begin{aligned} D_{KL}(p\|q_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}) &= \mathbb{E}_{x\sim p}\left[\log \frac{p(x)}{q(x|\boldsymbol{\theta})}\right] \\ &= \mathbb{E}_{x\sim p} \log p(x) - \mathbb{E}_{x\sim p} \log q(x|\boldsymbol{\theta}) \end{aligned}$$

as first term above does not depend on $\boldsymbol{\theta}$. Therefore,

$$\begin{aligned} \arg\min_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} D_{KL}(p\|q_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}) &= \arg\min_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} -\mathbb{E}_{x\sim p} \log q(x|\boldsymbol{\theta}) \\ &= \arg\max_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} \mathbb{E}_{x\sim p} \log q(x|\boldsymbol{\theta}) \end{aligned}$$

For a finite dataset of n samples from p, this is approximated as

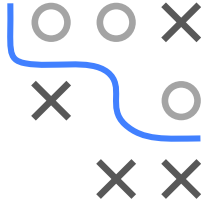
$$\arg\max_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} \mathbb{E}_{x\sim p} \log q(x|\boldsymbol{\theta}) \approx \arg\max_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \log q(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta}) \,.$$

This also directly implies an equivalence to risk minimization!

KL VS CROSS-ENTROPY I

From this here we can see much more:

$$\arg\min_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} D_{KL}(p\|q_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}) = \arg\min_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} -\mathbb{E}_{X\sim p} \log q(x|\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \arg\min_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} H(p\|q_{\boldsymbol{\theta}})$$

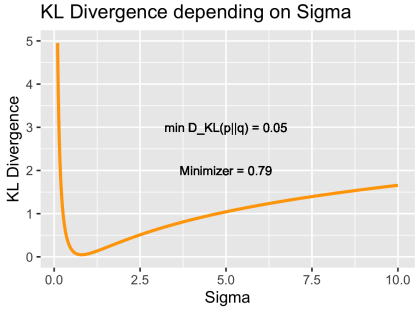


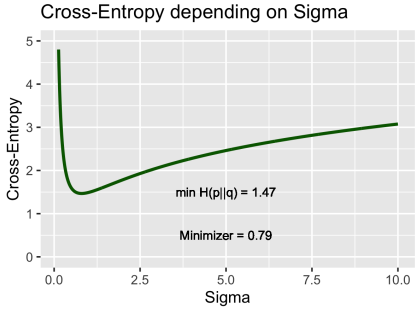
- So minimizing KL is the same as minimizing CE, is the same as maximum likelihood!
- We could now motivate CE as the "relevant" term that you have to minimize when you minimize KL - after you drop $\mathbb{E}_p \log p(x)$, which is simply the neg. entropy H(p)!
- Or we could say: CE between p and q is simply the expected negative log-likelihood of q, when our data comes from p!

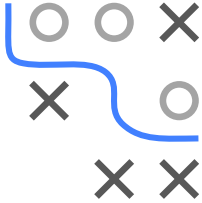
KL VS CROSS-ENTROPY EXAMPLE I

Let $p(x) = N(0, 1)$ and $q(x) = LP(0, \sigma)$ and consider again

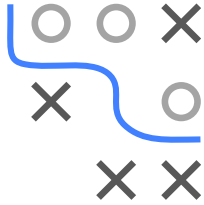
$$\arg\min_{\theta} D_{KL}(p\|q_\theta) = \arg\min_{\theta} -\mathbb{E}_{X\sim p} \log q(x|\theta) = \arg\min_{\theta} H(p\|q_\theta)$$



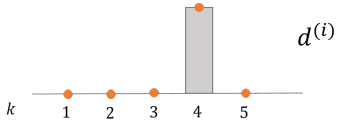


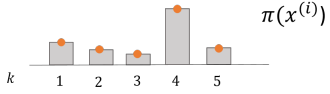


CROSS-ENTROPY VS. LOG-LOSS I



- Consider a multi-class classification task with dataset $\mathcal{D} = \left(\left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(1)}, y^{(1)} \right), \ldots, \left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(n)}, y^{(n)} \right) \right)$.
- For g classes, each $y^{(i)}$ can be one-hot-encoded as a vector $d^{(i)}$ of length g. $d^{(i)}$ can be interpreted as a categorical distribution which puts all its probability mass on the true label $y^{(i)}$ of $\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}$.
- $\pi(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta})$ is the probability output vector of the model, and also a categorical distribution over the classes.

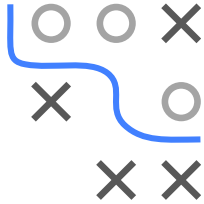




CROSS-ENTROPY VS. LOG-LOSS II

To train the model, we minimize KL between $d^{(i)}$ and $\pi(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta})$:

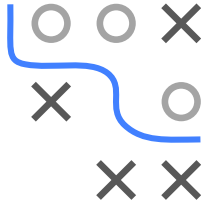
$$\arg\min_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} \sum_{i=1}^{n} D_{KL}(d^{(i)} \| \pi(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta})) = \arg\min_{\boldsymbol{\theta}} \sum_{i=1}^{n} H(d^{(i)} \| \pi(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta}))$$



We see that this is equivalent to log-loss risk minimization!

$$\begin{aligned}
R &= \sum_{i=1}^{n} H(d^{(i)} \| \pi_k(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta})) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(- \sum_{k} d_k^{(i)} \log \pi_k(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta}) \right) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} \underbrace{\left(- \sum_{k=1}^{g} [y^{(i)} = k] \log \pi_k(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta}) \right)}_{\text{log loss}} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n} (- \log \pi_{y^{(i)}}(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)}|\boldsymbol{\theta}))
\end{aligned}$$

CROSS-ENTROPY VS. BERNOULLI LOSS I

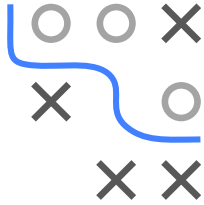


For completeness sake:
Let us use the Bernoulli loss for binary classification:

$$L(y, \pi(\boldsymbol{x})) = -y \log(\pi(\boldsymbol{x})) - (1 - y) \log(1 - \pi(\boldsymbol{x}))$$

If p represents a Ber(y) distribution (so deterministic, where the true label receives probability mass 1) and we also interpret $\pi(\boldsymbol{x})$ as a Bernoulli distribution Ber$(\pi(\boldsymbol{x}))$, the Bernoulli loss $L(y, \pi(\boldsymbol{x}))$ is the cross-entropy $H(p \| \pi(\boldsymbol{x}))$.

ENTROPY AS PREDICTION LOSS I



Assume log-loss for a situation where you only model with a constant probability vector π. We know the optimal model under that loss:

$$\pi_k = \frac{n_k}{n} = \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{n} [y^{(i)} = k]}{n}$$

What is the (average) risk of that minimal constant model?

$$\mathcal{R} = \frac{1}{n} \sum_{i=1}^{n} \left(- \sum_{k=1}^{g} [y^{(i)} = k] \log \pi_k \right) = - \frac{1}{n} \sum_{k=1}^{g} \sum_{i=1}^{n} [y^{(i)} = k] \log \pi_k$$

$$= - \sum_{k=1}^{g} \frac{n_k}{n} \log \pi_k = - \sum_{k=1}^{g} \pi_k \log \pi_k = H(\pi)$$

So entropy is the (average) risk of the optimal "observed class frequency" model under log-loss!